Technical 5-Whys — MindBridge Registration Failure

Fill in each field from your own DevTools Network investigation. Cite evidence (HTTP status, payload fields, response body) at each step. Save the completed file for the **SC14 Lab 2** RCA ticket.

Tester / role: Junior QA Tester **Date:** 14.10.2026 **Application:** MindBridge — `http://localhost:3000` **Screen:** `/register` (3-step wizard) → **Create account**

Problem statement

The user is on the registration form page.

Evidence captured (from the Network tab)

Item	**Value**
Request URL	http://localhost:3000/api/auth/register
Request method	POST
Status code	400 Bad Request
Request payload fields (sent)	{email: "learner-rca@example.com", password: "Password123", name: "RCA Tester",…}
dateOfBirth:	"2026-10-06"
email:	"learner-rca@example.com"
name:	"RCA Tester"
password:	"Password123"
region:	"london"
subscriptionTier:	"free"

Item	Value
Missing field (if any)	clientId
Response error code	missing_required_field
Response message	Missing required field: clientId
Evidence file(s) saved	registration-400-clientId.png, response-body.json

Paste the response body here:

json { "error": { "code": "missing_required_field", "message": "Missing required field: clientId", "field": "clientId" } }

The 5-Whys chain

Each answer must reference the evidence above, not a guess.

1. **Why did the user fail to register?** The UI displayed a generic "Registration failed. Please try again" error banner after submitting the form.
2. **Why did the UI show that error?** Because the POST /api/auth/register request returned an HTTP 400 Bad Request status code in the Network tab.
3. **Why did the server return that status?** The response body returned an error code of missing_required_field.
4. **Why was the request rejected?** The request payload sent by the frontend contained email, password, and name, but lacked the server-required clientId field.
5. **Why was that field never sent?** There is a client/server contract mismatch where the registration form UI fails to include the mandatory clientId parameter in the API request body. (Root Cause)

Root cause (one sentence)

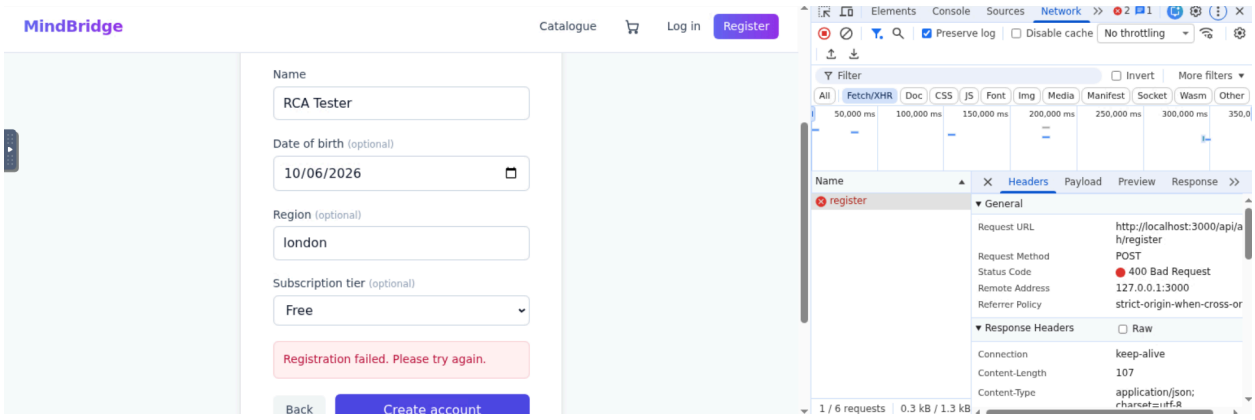
The registration request failed with a 400 Bad Request (missing_required_field) because the frontend failed to include the mandatory clientId field in the API payload.

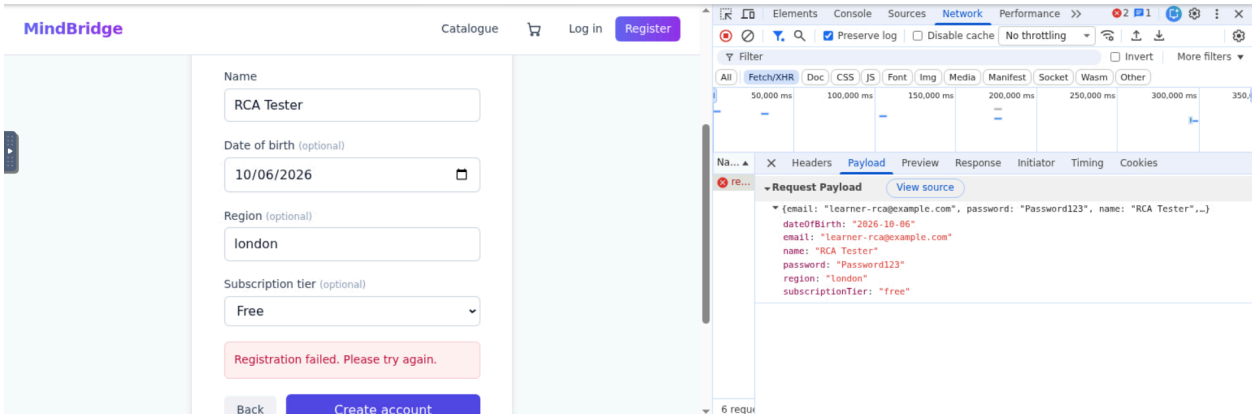
Suggested corrective direction (optional — you will detail this in Lab 2)

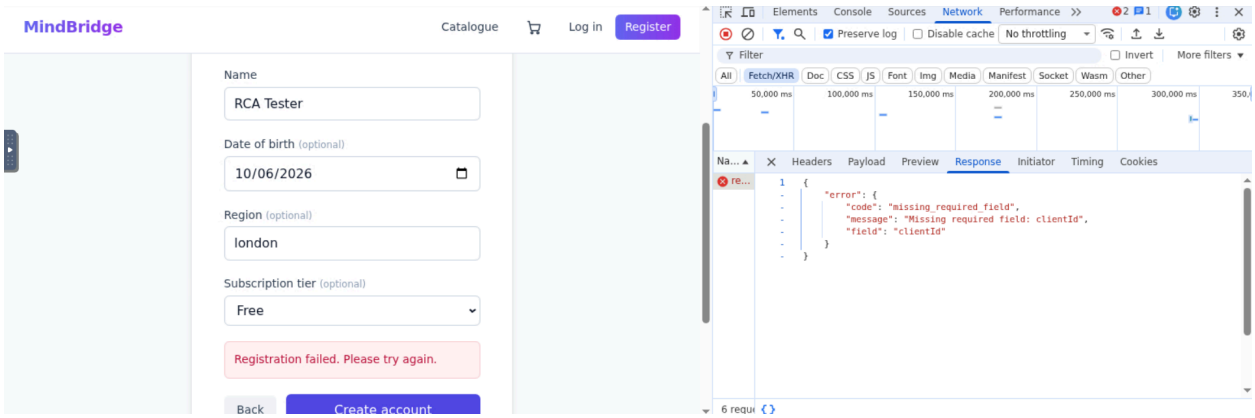
- **Fix:** Update the frontend registration form logic to include the clientId field in the POST /api/auth/register payload.
- **Prevention:** Implement contract testing or automated API validation tests to catch missing required request fields prior to deployment.

Self-check before you save

- ☑ Each "why" cites concrete evidence (status code / payload / response body).
- ☑ The response code `missing_required_field` and the field `clientId` are named explicitly.
- ☑ The chain ends at a **payload-contract gap**, not at an individual's mistake.
- ☑ Evidence files are saved and ready to attach to the RCA ticket.




MindBridge
Catalogue
Log in
Register
Name
RCA Tester
Date of birth (optional)
10/06/2026
Region (optional)
london
Subscription tier (optional)
Free
Registration failed. Please try again.
Back
Create account
Elements
Console
Sources
Network
Performance
Preserve log
Disable cache
No throttling
Filter
Invert
More filters
All
Fetch/XHR
Doc
CSS
JS
Font
Img
Media
Manifest
Socket
Wasm
Other
50,000 ms
100,000 ms
150,000 ms
200,000 ms
250,000 ms
300,000 ms
Headers
Payload
Preview
Response
Initiator
Timing
Cookies
Request Payload
View source
{email: "learner-rca@example.com", password: "Password123", name: "RCA Tester",…}
dateOfBirth: "2026-10-06"
email: "learner-rca@example.com"
name: "RCA Tester"
password: "Password123"
region: "london"
subscriptionTier: "free"


MindBridge
Catalogue
Log in
Register
Name
RCA Tester
Date of birth (optional)
10/06/2026
Region (optional)
london
Subscription tier (optional)
Free
Registration failed. Please try again.
Back
Create account
Elements
Console
Sources
Network
Performance
Preserve log
Disable cache
No throttling
Filter
Invert
More filters
All
Fetch/XHR
Doc
CSS
JS
Font
Img
Media
Manifest
Socket
Wasm
Other
50,000 ms
100,000 ms
150,000 ms
200,000 ms
250,000 ms
300,000 ms
Headers
Payload
Preview
Response
Initiator
Timing
Cookies
{
"error": {
"code": "missing_required_field",
"message": "Missing required field: clientId",
"field": "clientId"
}
}